34 Building background tasks and ser vices

This chapter covers

- Creating tasks that run in the background for your application
- Using the generic IHost to create Windows Services and Linux daemons
- Using Quartz.NET to run tasks on a schedule in a clustered environment

We've covered a lot of ground in the book so far. You've learned how to create page-based applications using Razor Pages and how to create APIs for mobile clients and services. You've seen how to add authentication and authorization to your application, use Entity Framework Core (EF Core) for storing state in the database, and create custom components to meet your requirements.

As well as using these UI-focused apps, you may find you need to build background or batch-task services. These services aren't meant to interact with users directly. Rather, they stay running in the background, processing items from a queue or periodically executing a long-running process.

For example, you might want to have a background service that sends email confirmations for e-commerce orders or a batch job that calculates sales and losses for retail stores after the shops close. ASP.NET Core includes support for these background tasks by providing abstractions for running a task in the background when your application starts.

In section 34.1 you'll learn about the background task support provided in ASP.NET Core by the `IHostedService` interface. You'll learn how to